

Snippets

Philips, Cisco form global alliance

Philips and Cisco have formed a global strategic alliance in a bid to create new value in energy savings, building efficiency and employee productivity, made possible by the Internet of Things (IoT) in modern offices. The alliance brings together Philips' LED based connected lighting system with Cisco's IT network to address a global office market estimated to be worth € 1 billion.

MediaTek Labs announces open source development platform

MediaTek Labs has announced MediaTek LinkIt Smart 7688, an open source development platform for a more connected world. The new platform runs OpenWrt Linux, offers a variety of programming options and enables rapid development of advanced Wi-Fi based devices like IP cameras, surveillance devices, smart appliances and Wi-Fi gateways that make use of cloud services.

Coal India to set up solar plants

State-run Coal India Ltd (CIL) plans to double its production capacity to a billion tonnes in the next five years. Additionally, it has committed to set up at least 1000MW of solar-power-generation plants in various states to compensate for greenhouse effects.

CIL has tied up with Indian Council of Forest Research and Education as well as National Energy Research Institute to find ways and means of producing coal through measures that would be beyond the mandatory environment norms. Central Mine Planning & Design Institute will work with the two institutions to ensure that coal production happens in the most eco-friendly manner.

Apart from this, via its subsidiary, South Eastern Coalfields, the company has invited tenders for setting up 200MW of solar-power-generation plants. It envisages setting up solar-power-generation plants of the said capacity in each tranche adding up to about 1000MW.

Government to distribute more than 60 million LED bulbs

The government is planning to distribute more than 60 million LED bulbs through State-run Energy Efficiency Services Ltd (EESL) in a span of one year. It has already distributed about 38 million LED bulbs through power-distribution companies under Domestic Efficient Lighting Programme (DELP).

ON Semiconductor acquires Fairchild Semiconductor

ON Semiconductor Corp. has acquired Fairchild Semiconductor International Inc. for US\$ 20 per share in an all-cash transaction valued at approximately US\$ 2.4 billion. The acquisition creates a leader in the power semiconductor market with combined revenue of approximately US\$ 5 billion, diversified across multiple markets with a strategic focus on automotive, industrial and smartphone end markets.

India lights up villages using LED lamps

More than 800 villages in Uttar Pradesh will be lit with 76,000 solar streetlighting units as part of a government initiative to drive sustainable electrification in rural areas in the country.

The project will provide electricity across 40 districts in the state. It has been developed by Philips Lighting in partnership with Uttar Pradesh New and Renewable Energy Development Agency.

Krishnan Pallassana, Climate Group, India director, comments, "This project shows the good things that happen when companies, people and the government work together. Importance of LED streetlights in terms of safety, emissions savings and money savings is clear, and The Climate Group is thrilled to see our partner, Philips Lighting, working to improve safety and quality of life for villagers in Uttar Pradesh."

The Climate Group has long advocated the benefits of LED streetlighting around the world and, in

2014, began a global consultation programme in partnership with Philips Lighting to address the remaining barriers to scaling up LED adoption. In India, it aims to improve the living conditions of rural communities by connecting them to clean energy as part of its core project, Bijli - Clean Energy for All.

Shenzhen govt to invest US\$ 200 million in Gujarat

Shenzhen city, which comes under the central government of China, is planning to invest US\$ 200 million in ZTEsoft's smartcity projects in Gujarat. Shenzhen government had signed two MoUs during Prime Minister Narendra Modi's visit in May 2015.

ZTEsoft is a subsidiary of ZTE Corp., the largest public telecom equipment manufacturer in China. It will offer financial assistance to develop and implement various facilities for smartcities in the state.

Samsung enters auto industry

Samsung Electronics has made an announcement that it will begin manufacturing electronics parts for the automotive industry, with specific focus on autonomous vehicles. The company revealed its plan during its annual structural reorganisation in order to pre-emptively respond to business uncertainties.

Initially, Samsung's automotive components team will focus on building electronics for infotainment and autonomous driving vehicles. The operation will be headed by EVP Jonghwan Park and overseen by VC and CEO Oh-Hyun Kwon.

The company's smartphone business has seen declining in terms of sales of late, so it has established a new automotive components team to target and pursue new business initiatives to prepare for future growth.

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